

Internship Host Quick-Reference

Vitchakorn (Blue) Poonyakanok, Summer 2027 Internship

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY

Heinz College, M.S. Health Care Analytics & IT
(MSHCA)

Last updated: August 29, 2026

WHO I AM

Physician and clinical data analyst from Bangkok, Thailand, now based in Pittsburgh, PA as a current M.S. student in Health Care Analytics and Information Technology at Carnegie Mellon University's Heinz College (August 2026 – May 2028). Background spans travel medicine, field epidemiology and outbreak investigation with Thailand's Ministry of Public Health, and applied health data analytics: clinical AI tools, public health dashboards, and disease-surveillance systems.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE & WHAT I CAN CONTRIBUTE

In an 8–12 week placement, I can contribute directly to analytics, dashboarding, or surveillance/evaluation work, for example:

- Built a disease-surveillance dashboard and LLM-based query assistant for Thailand's national disease-control agency, using tool-calling over aggregate, privacy-safe data.
- Designed a Tableau dashboard for yellow fever and malaria travel-prevention guidance, built on CDC Yellow Book data.
- Evaluated a national digital disease-surveillance system for sensitivity, timeliness, and representativeness.

INTERNSHIP WINDOW

Eligible window	May 11 – Aug 20, 2027
Minimum hours	300 hours
Duration needed	8–12 wks, full-time
Location	Pittsburgh or U.S. relocation
Work mode	On-site, or hybrid 60%+
Compensation	Paid or unpaid OK

ELIGIBLE HOST TYPES

- Public agency
- Non-profit organization
- Private firm

Per Heinz College policy, the role must have **significant educational value in management and analysis**, not purely clerical work.

ACADEMIC OVERSIGHT

- Internship is verified and formally approved by CMU Heinz College Career Services before it counts toward my degree requirement.
- At the end of the summer my supervisor completes two brief (~10 minute) evaluation forms, one for Heinz Career Services and one for CMU's Office of International Education. There is no ongoing reporting burden during the internship itself.
- No academic credit is issued, and there is no cost or contractual obligation to the host organization.

WORK AUTHORIZATION: WHAT HOSTING ACTUALLY REQUIRES

Status: J-1 Exchange Visitor, sponsored by Carnegie Mellon University

Authorization required: **Academic Training (AT)**, requested through CMU's Office of International Education. This is not CPT, not an H-1B, and not a petition the host files.

- **What the host provides is two documents.** (1) An offer letter stating: job title; the goals and objectives of the work; the **start and end dates**, the location, and hours per week; and the training supervisor's name and address. (2) A one-page OIE Employer Attestation — four fields and a signature — confirming the role meets those goals. **No sponsorship fee, no immigration petition, no legal filing.**
- **Timing:** OIE's processing time is 10 business days, and I may not begin work until the authorization is issued and its start date arrives. I file the day the signed offer letter is in hand.
- The role must be **on-site, or hybrid with more than 60% of working time on-site** — a U.S. Department of State condition on Academic Training. A fully remote role cannot be authorized.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

- **Is there a cost to host me?** No sponsorship fee, stipend, or contractual cost; compensation is optional (paid or unpaid).
- **Do you need to sponsor a visa?** No: CMU sponsors my J-1 status. Hosting takes an offer letter and one signed attestation page.
- **Can the role be fully remote?** No — Department of State rules require on-site or hybrid work, more than 60% of it on-site.
- **Where can you work?** I am based in Pittsburgh, PA and can relocate anywhere in the U.S. for the window.